Relocate: Client Acquisition Playbook

For Karan Somani. Prepared 13 October 2026. About 25 minutes to read.

1. The answer in one page

You have 80 hours a week, £300 a month, a strong Dubai network, a thin UK network, and eight weeks until you want your first paying family in December. That combination means one thing: **your Dubai contacts are your fastest route to clients, London networking is your second, and cold outreach is the engine that makes the numbers work.**

- **Fastest win (this week):** turn your Dubai property and services contacts into a source of families. Brokers, movers and school admissions teams already talk to UK families who are moving. They need someone to handle everything else. You become their "after-sales service", and they send you the family.
- **Biggest long-term channel:** UK wealth managers, private client tax advisers and lawyers. They see families leaving months before anyone else. Three good partners can fill your diary.
- **Cold engine:** LinkedIn plus cold email, run every day. Aim it mostly at advisers and founders, not at random wealthy people. Emailing advisers is easier legally and converts better.
- **Hot leads:** people who are publicly saying they're moving: LinkedIn posts, expat Facebook groups, Dubai property events in London, and families who've just enquired with a broker or mover.
- **The objection you must own:** the Iran conflict in March 2026. Tens of thousands of Britons left the Gulf. Every family will ask about safety. Turn it into your edge: every Relocate plan includes a contingency plan.
- **The maths:** £100k a month needs 3–4 families a month. That's roughly 15–20 discovery calls, from 60–100 real conversations, from 500–700 outreach touches a month. With 80 hours a week, that's very achievable.

2. The market in 2026: what's true and what's hype

Demand is real but smaller than the headlines.

- HMRC figures published in July 2026 show about **9,000 non-doms left the UK in the 2024–25 tax year**. The OBR's central forecast is about **10,800 a year**.
- The famous "16,500 millionaires leaving" figure came from a method its own publisher abandoned in June 2026. Don't quote it to anyone sophisticated. It makes you look like a property salesman.
- Henley estimated the UAE gained a net **9,800 millionaires in 2025**. That's contested, but the direction is clear.

Schools are still the pressure point.

- Taaleem says 9 of its 15 schools are full. Repton Al Barsha reports waiting lists in several year groups.
- Dubai opened 7 new schools this year (4 British, 3 IB), and Harrow International opened with about 400 founding pupils.
- So families still face competition for places. School urgency is your best sales lever.

The safety shock.

- After the Iranian strikes from late February 2026, at least **45,000 UK nationals left the Gulf** (some were tourists, and the school break was brought forward). About 240,000 Britons live in the UAE.
- Analysts expect many to return if the ceasefire holds. Some London agents report Gulf-based Britons enquiring about coming back.
- **What this means for you:** some families have paused. Those still moving are more anxious, so they want a trusted person more than ever. That works in your favour, if you address safety head-on (section 9).

3. Who exactly you're hunting

Family (primary):

- UK-based, net worth £5–15m, children aged 4–16.
- Usually led by a business owner, senior finance professional or founder, often with a PA or family office.
- The children's schooling decision is frequently led by the mother. Speak to both parents.

Founder (secondary):

- Recently sold a company or raised a big round. Thinking about tax, lifestyle and the UAE's start-up ecosystem.
- Faster decisions, less school pressure, more interested in company setup and banking.

Trigger events that make someone "in market" right now:

- A company sale or liquidity event: announced on LinkedIn, Sifted, the press, or Companies House changes.
- A prime London home listed for sale or rent.
- A UK school notice period coming up (the Christmas and Easter term deadlines).
- A job move to DIFC, or a firm opening a Dubai office.
- A public post: "we're moving to Dubai", "any advice on schools in Dubai?"
- Enquiries made to a Dubai broker, mover or school from a UK number.

4. The funnel maths (pin this to your wall)

Stage	Per month	Per week
Outreach touches (messages, emails, intros, event chats)	600	150
Real conversations (replies, coffees, calls)	80	20
Discovery calls with a family or founder	16–20	4–5
Proposals sent	8	2

Families signed	3–4	1

Assumptions: 10–15% of cold touches turn into conversations, and about 1 in 5 discovery calls turns into a signed client. Warm referrals convert 3–5 times better than cold. **Every warm partner you sign reduces the cold volume you need.**

Track only four numbers each Friday: touches, conversations, discovery calls, signed clients.

5. HOT: people moving right now

These are your highest-value targets. Respond within hours, not days.

1. Your Dubai brokers' UK buyers (start tomorrow)

- Every prime broker in Dubai has UK families mid-purchase who still need schools, visas, a container and banking. The broker wants the deal to close smoothly and the family to stay happy.
- Offer: "Send me your UK families who are relocating. I'll handle everything except the property, so they never get distracted or delayed. Any property search they still need comes straight back to you."
- That last line matters: you never compete with the broker.

2. International movers and the survey request

- A family requesting a removal survey is the hottest lead in the market. Movers hear about the move before the family has sorted schools or visas.
- Pitch the UK–Dubai desks at accredited movers: "When you survey a family moving to Dubai, give them my timeline. I send every family I sign back to you for the move."

3. Dubai school admissions teams

- Admissions staff answer anxious UK parents every day. They can't recommend brokers or visas, but they can hand out a useful one-page timeline.

- Visit, drop off printed timelines, and offer to help families who are struggling with paperwork. Be useful and never pushy.

4. Public "we're moving" signals (daily, 20 minutes)

- Search LinkedIn posts every day for "moving to Dubai", "relocating to Dubai", "Dubai schools". Filter to people in the UK.
- Join and watch the expat groups: Dubai Expat Community on Facebook, Mumsnet's Living Overseas board, British expat forums.
- Rule for groups: give genuinely useful answers and never pitch in public. When someone asks a detailed question, answer it in full, then add "happy to send you my one-page timeline if useful." Move to a private message only when they say yes.

5. Dubai property events in London

- Dubai developers and brokers regularly run property shows in Mayfair hotels, Emirates Stadium and similar venues (Accrue lists many).
- Every attendee is thinking about Dubai, and many are moving, not just investing. Go to every one.
- Don't work the crowd like a salesman. Partner with an exhibiting broker you know: stand with them, and be their "relocation expert".

6. WARM: building a network fast in London

Your UK network is thin, so build one on purpose. You're in London now: use it.

Your target partner list (aim for 10 signed by end of December):

- 3 UK private client tax advisers who specialise in non-doms and people leaving the UK. They see every departure and must refer the non-tax work somewhere.
- 3 wealth managers or private bankers with clients in Dubai (ideally with a DIFC office).
- 2 private client or family lawyers (wills, trusts, divorce-proofing before a move).

- 2 prime London estate or letting agents (they know who's selling up).

Where to find them in London:

- LinkedIn first (section 7), then ask for a 20-minute coffee near their office. People say yes to coffee with someone useful.
- Events: wealth and private client industry events, Chambers of Commerce, Arab–British business events, founder and investor events, and Dubai property shows. Search Eventbrite and Meetup weekly for "Dubai", "UAE", "private client", "wealth", "founder".
- British Business Group Dubai and the British Chamber of Commerce Dubai for the Dubai side. Join when budget allows; attend open events now.

The partner pitch (say it in under 30 seconds):

> *"When your clients move to Dubai, the move is where things go wrong: school places, visas, the house, the container. I handle all of it, with one person and one plan. Your client lands well and stays your client. And when they need Dubai-side advice, I send them back to you, or to your Dubai desk."*

Make it two-way. Partners send you clients when you send them clients, or when you make them look good. Track what you've given each partner as carefully as what you've received.

Your existing Dubai network, used properly. List every Dubai contact you have, in every category from the timeline. For each one ask: "Who in your world talks to UK families before they move?" Every broker, mover, school, PRO and interior designer knows someone. Ask each for two introductions.

7. COLD: the engine (most of your 80 hours)

Cold outreach is a numbers game played with precision. Do it every day, at the same time, without fail.

7a. Set-up (this week, before sending anything)

- **Domain and email.** Buy a domain and set up Google Workspace (about £16 a month in total). Gmail addresses kill credibility, and sending volume from them gets you flagged.
- **A second domain just for cold email** (e.g. a variation of your main one). This protects your main email's reputation.
- **LinkedIn profile.** A professional photo, and the headline "Private relocation for UK families moving to Dubai | schools, visas, homes, everything". Put the timeline in your Featured section. Post twice a week (section 8).
- **A simple website.** One page on Framer with the timeline and a private enquiry form. Without a website, cold emails look like spam.
- **Tools within £300 a month:**
- LinkedIn Sales Navigator (about £80): for searching and saved lists.
- Apollo or Hunter free tier: for finding work email addresses.
- A free CRM, or Airtable: to track every contact.

7b. Who to target cold (in order of value)

1. **Advisers: tax, wealth, legal, estate agents.** This is business-to-business: easiest legally, highest value per relationship.
2. **Founders and business owners** who show trigger events (exits, funding, posts about Dubai). Contact them on LinkedIn, or at their company email address.
3. **PAs and family-office staff.** They organise moves and they're reachable. A PA who loves you will bring the family.
4. **Wealthy individuals with no trigger.** Lowest yield. Don't spend time here.

7c. The legal line (UK rules for cold contact)

- Under PECR (the UK's electronic marketing rules), emailing **company** addresses (Ltd, PLC, LLP) is generally allowed without prior consent. Emailing **individuals, sole traders and ordinary partnerships** generally needs consent.
- UK GDPR still applies to any personal data you process:
- Have a legitimate reason for contacting each person, and write it down.
- Say who you are and where you got their details.
- Include an easy opt-out, and honour it immediately.
- Cold calls to personal numbers are restricted by the Telephone Preference Service. Call businesses, not people's mobiles.
- **In practice:** cold email advisers and founders at their company addresses. Reach individuals through LinkedIn conversations and introductions. Check the ICO's own guidance before you scale.

7d. The daily cold routine (about 4–5 hours)

- **25 LinkedIn connection requests** to targets, with no note or a short one. Accepted connections convert better than cold notes.
- **15 LinkedIn follow-up messages** to new connections (scripts below).
- **30–40 cold emails** to adviser company addresses, built up gradually (start at 10 a day for 2 weeks so your new domain isn't flagged).
- **10 trigger searches:** LinkedIn posts mentioning Dubai moves, new exits, new DIFC hires. Contact each personally.
- **Follow up everything 3 times**, about 4, 7 and 14 days apart. Most replies come on the second or third message.

7e. Scripts

LinkedIn, after a founder accepts:

> *Thanks for connecting, [Name]. Saw [the exit / your post about Dubai]. Congratulations. I run Relocate: we handle the whole move to Dubai for UK families, from schools and visas to the house and container. If Dubai's on the cards, I've got a one-page family timeline I can send you.*

It's useful whether you use us or not.

LinkedIn, follow-up (no reply, day 7):

One timing point, [Name]: for September 2027 entry, Dubai school assessments and applications open this winter, and the good schools fill up early. Happy to send the timeline if useful.

Cold email to an adviser:

Subject: Your clients moving to Dubai

Hi [Name], I run Relocate. We handle the full move to Dubai for UK families worth £5–15m: schools, visas, the home, freight, banking and household staff. I spend half the year in Dubai and have vetted contacts across the city.

Advisers tell me the move is when clients get stressed and relationships wobble. We make sure your client lands well, and we refer Dubai-side advice back to you or your Dubai desk.

Worth a 20-minute coffee? I'm in London until [date].

Karan Somani | Relocate | +44 7759 760974 If you'd rather not hear from me, just reply "no" and I won't contact you again.

Cold email follow-up 1 (day 4):

Hi [Name], attaching our one-page UK to Dubai family timeline, in case it's useful to share with a client. Happy to talk whenever suits.

Cold email follow-up 2 (day 14):

Last note from me, [Name]. If a client is weighing up Dubai this winter, I'm happy to give them a free 15-minute call on schools and timing, with no obligation. Just forward this email.

7f. Physical cold outreach (stand out)

- Hand-deliver or post a printed timeline with a short handwritten note to 10 wealth management and private client tax offices a week in the City and Mayfair.
- Almost nobody does this any more. It gets remembered, and it costs pennies.

7g. Paid ads with £300 a month (test, don't bet)

- Don't run ads until the website and timeline are live.
- **Meta (Facebook/Instagram):** £5 a day for 2–3 weeks. Target London and the South East, aged 35–55, with interests in Dubai, international schools and private education. Offer the free timeline in exchange for an email address.
- **Google Search:** a small test on terms like "moving to Dubai with family", "Dubai school places for UK children". Cap spend tightly. These clicks can be expensive.
- Skip LinkedIn ads. They're too expensive for your budget.
- Kill any ad that hasn't produced a qualified conversation after £100. Ads are a supplement. Your edge is relationships.

8. Content: support act, not the main show

Wealthy families and advisers will look you up before they reply. Your LinkedIn has to answer "is this person real and expert?"

- **Post twice a week** on LinkedIn. Real, specific Dubai knowledge, for example:
- "The 3 deadlines UK families miss when moving to Dubai"
- "What September entry at Dubai's top British schools actually requires"
- "Renting vs buying in your first Dubai year"
- "How we plan for contingencies after March 2026"
- Once a week, post an anonymised story: "This week a London family of four…" (only once you have clients).

- Instagram and TikTok can work later. Not before your first three families.

9. Objections and how to answer them

"Is Dubai safe after the Iran strikes?"

> *"It's the first question every family asks, and it should be. Every plan we build has a contingency plan: rental terms that give you flexibility, documents kept ready to travel, insurance that covers disruption, and an agreed plan if you need to leave quickly. We don't tell you it's risk-free. We make sure you're prepared."*

Never dismiss the concern, and never give security advice you aren't qualified to give.

"Why not just use the broker or a moving company?"

> *"They're experts in one piece. We run the whole thing, schools to staff, so nothing falls between the gaps. And we bring you the best broker and mover too."*

"You're one person."

> *"That's the point. You get me, not a call centre. Behind me is a vetted network of licensed specialists. I keep it to a small number of families at a time so I can do it properly."*

"It's expensive."

> *"One missed school deadline or one wrong visa route costs more than our fee, and costs your family months. Most clients find our introductions save more than the fee."*

Only say the last part if it's true in their case.

"Do you get paid by the people you introduce?"

> *"Sometimes, and you'll see every one in writing. We never introduce someone because they pay us. If a better option doesn't pay us, you get the better option."*

10. Your 8-week sprint (13 October to 8 December)

Week 1 (13–19 Oct): foundations

- Domain, professional email, LinkedIn profile, one-page website with the timeline.
- List every Dubai contact. Message the 10 most useful ones, asking for UK families.
- Pitch 3 brokers on the "after-sales service" deal.

Week 2 (20–26 Oct): partners

- Start the cold engine at low volume.
- 5 coffees with London advisers.
- Visit 2 Dubai school admissions teams (or call them while in London).
- Attend at least 1 event.

Weeks 3–4 (27 Oct – 9 Nov): volume

- Full daily routine (150 touches a week).
- Ads test starts.
- Aim for 3 discovery calls.
- Offer a founding-family price (£9k for the Family package) for the first 3 families only.

Weeks 5–6 (10–23 Nov): convert

- Proposals out. Follow up hard, using school deadlines as genuine urgency.
- Sign partner agreements with your top 3 referrers.

Weeks 7–8 (24 Nov – 8 Dec): close and deliver

- Close the first 1–2 founding families.
- Start delivery immediately: their success becomes your case study.

An 80-hour week, roughly:

- **Mornings (3h):** cold LinkedIn and email.
- **Late morning (2h):** follow-ups, replies, trigger searches.
- **Afternoons (3h):** coffees, calls, office drop-offs.
- **Evenings (2–3h, 3–4 times a week):** events and networking.
- **One half-day a week:** content and admin. Friday: review the four numbers.

11. Mistakes to avoid

- Spending weeks perfecting the portal or website instead of talking to people. Nobody buys a website.
- Pitching wealthy people cold with no trigger or introduction. Low yield, and it damages your reputation.
- Quoting hyped "millionaire exodus" figures to sophisticated advisers.
- Promising school places, visa outcomes or safety. Promise process and effort only.
- Taking any payment off the books. One rumour ends your credibility with advisers.
- Ignoring the founder segment. Founders decide fast and pay fast, which makes them good first clients even though families are the core business.

12. Questions to answer before Wednesday

1. Which 10 Dubai contacts will you message first, and who in their world sees UK families?
2. Which 3 brokers will you pitch the "after-sales service" deal to this week?
3. What's your domain name? Buy it today.
4. Which London events can you attend in the next 14 days?
5. What's your founding-family price, and how many spots (suggested: 3 at £9k)?

6 What's your answer when a family asks "how many families have you moved?" Be honest: "You'd be one of our founding families, and here's why that's good for you."

Sources

- HMRC non-dom departures and OBR forecasts, via landeddubai.com/blogs/tax/millionaires-leaving-uk
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- deVere Group: Britain's 2026 millionaire exodus (devere-group.com)
- Khaleej Times: UAE schools 2026–2027, what's new on campus (khaleejtimes.com)
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- The New Arab: One in eight Britons left UAE amid Iran war (newarab.com)
- Accrue: Dubai property expo listings in London (accrue.com/events)
- Global Law Experts: B2B email marketing rules UK (globallawexperts.com)
- Prospeo: are cold emails legal in 2026 (prospeo.io)
- GlobalData and Invesco research on HNW referral channels (globaldata.com, invesco.com)
- Gulf News: Dubai Expat Community group profile (gulfnews.com)

Note: many sources are commercial sites. HMRC and OBR are the most reliable figures here. This is general guidance, not legal advice; check the ICO's guidance on electronic marketing before scaling cold email.